

Student Evaluation of Teaching, 2025 Fall
Allen Wilson, POLI 100-005 INTRO AMERICAN DEMOCRACY
Mode: IP (In Person)

Raters	Students
Responded	20
Invited	43
Response Ratio	46.5%

	Mean	Median	SD	N	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
1. Overall, I learned a great deal from this course.	4.85	5.00	0.37	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.0%	85.0%
2. The instructor treated all students with respect.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
3. The instructor encouraged students to participate in this class.	4.80	5.00	0.41	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.0%	80.0%
4. The instructor saw cultural and personal differences as assets.	4.80	5.00	0.52	20	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	10.0%	85.0%
5. I could really be myself in this course.	4.70	5.00	0.57	20	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	20.0%	75.0%
6. In this course I had multiple opportunities to express my viewpoints and questions.	4.75	5.00	0.64	20	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	5.0%	85.0%
7. The course challenged me to think deeply about the subject matter.	4.75	5.00	0.55	20	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	15.0%	80.0%
8. The design of this course (e.g., its format, selected materials, assignments, exercises, quizzes, etc.) helped me better understand the subject matter.	4.80	5.00	0.41	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.0%	80.0%
9. Overall, this course was excellent.	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%

11. The instructor held class meetings consistent with the official schedule published for this course.		
N	Yes	No
20	100.0%	0.0%

Department Specific

Political Science Undergraduate: Instructor Ratings

	Mean	Median	SD	N	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
1. Demonstrates enthusiasm about teaching.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
2. Communicates clearly and logically.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
3. Promotes a climate of mutual respect.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
4. Encourages student questions.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
5. Emphasizes critical thinking.	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%
6. Uses teaching strategies that promote active involvement.	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%
7. Clearly communicates expectations for student performance.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
8. Regularly provides constructive criticism of student performance.	4.95	5.00	0.23	19	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.3%	94.7%
9. Provides timely feedback on student performance.	4.89	5.00	0.32	19	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.5%	89.5%
10. Provides a fair evaluation of student performance.	4.95	5.00	0.23	19	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.3%	94.7%
11. Is available when needed.	5.00	5.00	0.00	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	100.0%
12. Is well-prepared for instruction.	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%
13. Overall, considering both the possibilities and limitations of the subject matter and course, I would rate this instructor as "excellent."	4.95	5.00	0.22	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	5.0%	95.0%

Political Science Undergraduate: Course Quality Ratings

	Mean	Median	SD	N	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
14. Course goals and objectives are clearly specified.	4.80	5.00	0.41	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.0%	80.0%
15. Requirements (e.g., assignments, attendance, student responsibilities) are clearly specified.	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%
16. Course assignments are clearly related to the course objectives.	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%
17. Instructional methods in the course facilitate my learning.	4.85	5.00	0.37	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.0%	85.0%
18. In general, the course is well-organized.	4.80	5.00	0.41	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.0%	80.0%
19. Course materials stimulated critical thinking.	4.85	5.00	0.37	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.0%	85.0%
20. I know significantly more about this subject than before I took this course.	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%
21. Overall, considering its content, design, and structure, I would rate this course as "excellent."	4.90	5.00	0.31	20	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	10.0%	90.0%

Open-Ended Responses

1. In what ways did your instructor make learning possible for you during the semester?

Comments
He encourages questions and is incredibly flexible with students' needs and schedules.
He was always open to discussing anything, and he encouraged us to take different viewpoints. I appreciated how he provided grace days for assignments; there were times I really needed them, and they relieved stress. I liked how he provided relatable examples during class so we could be more engaged and it helped with my understanding of some topics. He was very funny, and I can tell he got really comfortable with lecturing towards the end of the semester compared to the beginning of the semester so that was nice to see.
He made sure you understood and also gave tips and engaging lectures.
He was available in and out of class, and sent the slideshows to us!
Made the content engaging and fun
He often gave examples to help us understand more complicated topics. We also watched fun videos to help us. Allen also gave us many opportunities to ask questions.
Instructor Allen Wilson really supported my learning this semester by being patient, encouraging, and always willing to clarify anything we didn't understand. He explained the content clearly and created an environment where I felt comfortable participating and asking questions. His enthusiasm for the subject made the class more engaging and helped me stay interested.
Allen is so, so, so excellent to be a political science TA. He makes every slide and his lecture contents accessible online. He combines the lecture and videos together to make things clear to everyone, and he is not a strict grader, which makes the course not so difficult even for non-majors.
Allen is an excellent professor, he is always excited to answer questions and is always able to tie in students' answers to his questions in an encouraging way. He is extremely reachable outside of class and has been incredibly fair with me through a bumpy semester. His energy and excitement absolutely makes content that may otherwise be somewhat dull (Federalist Papers) interesting.
He explained the material very well in all of the lectures. He answered any questions that anyone had, and he is also super accommodating with the work that he gave the class. I like how he understood that sometimes other things may take up some of our time and he gave us grace days to make up that work.
Provided many opportunities in class to answer and ask questions about content that we were currently learning.
Professor Wilson is the best professor that I met this semester! he is super helpful in everything, and will be happy to answer any question you have. He is also giving me lots of advice on papers and exams in office hours. Overall, his classes are also super interesting since he is a chill person and always have lots of cool examples in the slides.
Allen made all classes and material interesting with different news links, videos, research, polls, etc. He backed up all of his teachings with a lot of facts, and was just a lot of fun and interesting in general.
He created a learning environment that was welcoming and productive, and went out of his way to find ways to help us engage with the material. He made sure students were always aware of academic resources. He went out of his way to create classwork that would genuinely help students improve, and was always willing to offer assistance when any student was uncertain about material. Definitely one of my favorite professors here at UNC.
Professor Wilson is an amazing teacher. His lessons were clear and direct as well as fun and super informative. He made me super interested in every class and was overall a funny, great guy. He's very passionate about his subject and you can tell. He is a great guy and a great teacher.
He always made an effort to be available during office hours. He also always made helpful materials from class available on Canvas. Finally, when I had a schedule complication for a midterm, he was very understanding and accommodating.
He provided so many resources for us to use outside of the class and was very transparent.
Very available during office hours. I went multiple times and he not only answered questions specific to course material, but also would help me think about other issues and just discuss ideas with me, whether for class or not.

2. Which aspects of this course should be kept for future times this course is taught?

Comments
Having tiered weights to the three exams (the highest grade being worth 25%, the lowest grade being worth 5%, etc.). Having 3 grace days for assignments.
I liked the material
all of it! It's amazing.
Everything!
I liked it when we went through the process of how a bill becomes a law. We broke up into the House and the Senate and got to do it ourselves. I learned a lot from this. I also liked the way he did exams. There was a variety which I liked.
The organized structure of the course should definitely be kept. The way the lessons and assignments were laid out made it easy to follow, and the in-class examples and explanations were really helpful for understanding the material. The option for exam layout was also a very cool aspect.
Allen Wilson being the lecturer. And also the grading system is good.
All aspects, this is an excellently designed course.
I like everything that was in this class. I like how he grades the exams because if they were not graded in that way than I may have been in bad spot, but he was once again accommodating.
All of it, I really enjoyed this course, and I love Professor Allen. So sweet and so entertaining.
Allen Wilson.
All of it in my opinion. Done very well.
Reflection papers, small lecture group (combining lecture with recitation if able), study guides
all aspects. It was a great course.
All of it, and Allen Wilson.
I liked the group activities as it fostered collaboration.
Definitely allowing the rough draft submission before the final paper. That aspect was very helpful. I also think the reflection formatting was good and did incentivize deeper consideration and research of our readings.

Department Specific

Please comment on the strengths of the course.

Comments
wide range of conversation,
Very easy to follow content and course format
– interesting – broken up well between units – covers the past and present
Instructor Wilson broke down the material in a way that was approachable and connected everything to examples that helped reinforce the content. The class also had a very supportive atmosphere, which made participating and asking questions feel comfortable.
The course is an excellent intro course to political science in the United States that is accessible to everyone. The course provides a good structure and covers the most important parts of American politics.
The largest strengths of this course are the reading reflections, as we are able to pick the reading that most interests us and engage with it deeply and think critically and bring in our own arguments. (This is how all reading should be done, and when it comes to learning about how American politics work, it is imperative that we have a deeper understanding). The multiple choice questions are straightforward and the essay questions on the test likewise encouraged a deeper learning. It was exciting to understand a discharge petition when reading the recent news.
Everything was wonderful in this class.
Well-designed course, a sweet and well-educated professor on the topic, overall great course.
the course is well structured and is kept interesting.
The course was well designed to make sure that students are learning and not just going for grades, with things like grace days, an available professor, and rough drafts.
Informative, well-structured (chronologically), manageable course-load
Lots of opportunities to do well. He gives you all the tools to succeed.
Well defined and well organized.
Very organized and easy to follow.
– I like the unit breakup. It builds on itself well and in a logical manner. – The feedback on the writing from Prof. Wilson was wonderful too. Professors sometimes require high-quality writing but don't ever provide feedback or expectations, which feels challenging. – Good distribution of different kinds of required readings too. It was a nice mix of primary sources, secondary analysis, research papers, etc.
I appreciated how the course was sectioned into three parts: it was easy to digest each section and with every section, I was able to apply knowledge from the previous section to understand the current one.

Please comment on the limitations of the course.

Comments
exams were hard becuase there was so much material covered.
n/z
– lots of information
A limitation of the course is that it depends heavily on writing. Students who don't feel confident in their writing skills may find the workload challenging, since a lot of the assignments require clear and detailed written work.
This course is still a bit hard for students that do not know about American politics well based on my observation, so its difficulty still has a room to reduce, especially the difficulties of the exams.
Honestly, the fluorescent lights in the classroom were very distracting, I don't know if there's a half-on/half-off setting but that would be nice.
There were no limitations
None
none
There really aren't any.
n/a
None.
Lots of material for a short amount of time.
There was not always chances to collaborate.
– I would've loved some sort of interactive component for the class more often, maybe once per unit? The day where we did the Congress simulation was a big highlights and helped me synthesize the related course material. Something like that for the constitution and founding unit and the public opinion, parties, elections unit would be fun too.
N/A

Please comment on the strengths of the instructor.

Comments
I can tell he enjoys teaching, and I loved how open he was to class discussions. He was always open to questions and concerns we had.
was very personable and explains things easily.
HE IS THE BEST! Made learning so much fun and was always available.
– super helpful – funny in class (helps keep content interesting) – gives good feedback on essays – grades tests and essays relatively quickly
Mr. Wilson's strengths include how engaging he is and how easily he connects with students. He creates a positive and comfortable classroom environment that makes it easier to participate and stay involved in the material.
Allen Wilson is an excellent storyteller and lecturer. His lectures are very interesting, and with his slides, everything is shown clearly to students.
Energy, passion, understanding, humor, reachability, patience, and kindness. Enough said.
Everything that he did was great, I do not think that he should change anything about his class.
So sweet, super funny, very flexible, but also very balanced and willing to talk about anything and considers all perspectives.
Again, best professor.
He's very fun, unique, and interesting and backs up all of his teachings with facts.
Engaging, helpful, knowledgeable about the topic, patient,
He's funny, intelligent, informed, precise, overall, a great guy and teacher.
enthusiastic, accommodating, well-prepared, and organized.
Very knowledgeable, organized, and willing to work with anyone.
– Very understanding with students for deadlines and work – Very open during office hours to explore questions and help students think through ideas for their own interests or written assignments – Provides great feedback on writing – Helpful, accommodating, and flexible with exams – Funny and engaging during class – not overly serious

Please comment on the limitations of the instructor.

Comments
none
n/a
None
A minor limitation is that he tends to stall or pause with filler words fairly often. It's not a big problem, but smoothing out those moments could make his explanations feel even clearer and more direct.
Not very experienced I guess?
Nothing comes to mind!
No limitations
none
none
Maybe some nervousness at the beginning of teaching the course but became much more comfortable as the class progressed.
n/a
none
None, he's great!
N/A
None!